Turning yield into loyalty

A short POV on Perena's growth problem, and one idea I couldn't stop thinking about

Tashoma Vilini, ahead of the Marketing Lead conversation. Written quickly and informally, so treat it as a sketch, not a finished plan.

The real problem isn't awareness. It's trust and staying power.

From the outside, the numbers say the product works. USD* has paid real yield, it is liquid, and people have shown up. The honest gap is the one Anna has named herself: a lot of those people are smart about their money and will move it the moment they see a better number somewhere else. The goal isn't ten thousand users who pass through. It is a thousand who stay because they trust you.

That reframes the whole marketing job. The benchmark for USD* is not the highest APY in DeFi. It is the bank or the broker the person already uses and already trusts. You win that comparison on two things money usually can't buy quickly: trust, and a reason to let capital settle in.

So I would point the growth function at three moves.

1. Measure what actually matters. Not volume, not followers, not points handed out. Deposits and retention by channel, every week. The first job is to name the loyal cohort precisely: where did the capital that is still here in month three actually come from. Everything else gets optimised toward that, not toward top-of-funnel vanity.

2. Tell the truth, beautifully. For a savings product, transparency is the marketing. Plain-English explanations of every yield source, where it comes from, and what could go wrong, published on a rhythm. Perena Purple is already the seed of this. Scaled and made beautiful, radical transparency is how you out-trust a bank. (Sample issue attached separately.)

3. Reward staying, not chasing. This is where the standard crypto playbook fails you, and where I think there is a genuinely different model to run.

The idea: Roots

A loyalty layer that rewards capital for staying, not for arriving.

Why the usual model is the trap. Airdrops and points weighted by deposit size buy exactly the wrong customer. They reward the size and speed of the money, so you attract money that is fast and mercenary by design. When the points slow down, it leaves, and the TVL chart tells the story. You pay to acquire the customer you least want.

Roots flips the weighting from size to time. It fits the family you already have: Seeds are how people arrive, Roots are what grows when they stay. Three mechanics:

1. **Tenure multiplier.** Rewards are weighted by how long your capital has stayed, not how much arrived. A small, patient deposit can out-earn a large, restless one. Withdraw, and your multiplier resets to zero. The incentive now pulls toward exactly the behaviour you want, which is staying.

2. **Referrals that only count when capital takes root.** A referrer earns nothing at deposit. They earn once the capital they brought has stayed past a set window, say ninety days. Overnight this turns your ambassador program from a machine that recruits mercenaries into one that recruits loyal capital, because people only get paid for bringing money that behaves.

3. **Loyalty is the gate to the best things.** The most patient capital gets first access to new vaults and tranches, into Purple, and to the real-world perks and deal flow. Today the best yield is the reward for chasing. Here, the best of Perena is the reward for trusting.

Why it suits Perena specifically. It is on-brand rather than bolted on, it is built to grow the thousand who love you rather than the ten thousand who pass through, and it is a different model from the airdrop race that Anna has said she is tired of. It is also legible to a non-crypto saver, which matters if the consumer and emerging-market direction is real, because "the longer you save, the more you earn, and the more you unlock" is a sentence anyone's mother understands.

It is not a finished mechanism. Sustainability of the reward budget, the exact curve of the tenure multiplier, and the soft-versus-hard treatment of withdrawals all need real modelling. But the shape feels right, and it is the kind of thing I would want to build with you in the first ninety days.

I wrote this because I couldn't stop thinking about the problem after going deep on what you are building. Happy to be wrong on any of it. That's half the fun.